

lost on balance. If he has lost, which will probably be the case, there is all the more reason for not continuing, for he is as certain then as the day dawns, to increase it by going in heavily, or "plunging," as it is termed. If he retires from the scene, and permits his nerves to recover, he will return to be "cleaned" out in a more wholesome frame of mind, which will enable him finally to quit such haunts without probably resorting to such desperate measures as might have been adopted, had his coffers been emptied all at once under a July sun.

At all events, the most methodical and prudent speculator, who manages to amuse himself, and by extreme care, like good whist players, leaves off at the end of six months about even, would not dispute the wisdom of closing his book when all the world was going away for their holidays.

As the first half of the year is favourable for the bull speculator, so the second half is more likely to favour the operations of the bear. When people have had their outing and spent their money, they return to business, and to think of the necessity of prudently providing the comforts needful in the chilly autumn and cold winter. Business begins to slacken in many important branches with the approach of that period of the year when the days and nights come to be of equal length all over the earth, except just under the pole. There may be a good deal of money about at such periods, and yet very little investment business going on in the stock markets. It should be remembered that large extra accumulations of money at the great centres very often mean, in fact, generally, an unprofitable state of trade; and when the foreign shipments leave no profit, from the great merchant princes down through every link in the chain to the labourer at thirty shillings a week, the effect is felt, and there being no profits, there is obviously nothing in the shape of surplus gain to invest. On the contrary, most people wish to sell. In the later months of the year locomotion for nearly all purposes begins to diminish both as regards business and pleasure, which affects the receipts of the railway companies. If